

Unit 5, Lesson 5: Paying Your Way in Mathlandia

Benchmark

MA.7.AR.3.3 Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving the conversion of units across different measurement systems.

Learning Target

- ☐ I can determine the exchange rate between two forms of currency.

5.5.1 Warm-Up: Currency Exchanges

If you travel to another country, chances are you'll need to exchange currency. For example, this could mean exchanging U.S. dollars for pesos of an equivalent value while visiting Mexico. Almost no two currencies are worth the same amount and their values change daily, sometimes even hourly. Currency exchange rates are used to determine the equivalent values at the time of exchange.



1. What are two things you wonder about currency exchanges?

An example of a currency exchange calculator is shown.

2. What are two things you notice?

1	United States Dollar	=	0.8566	Euro
	10		USD - United Sta...	▼
	8.57		EUR - Euro	▼

3. Peyton wrote the currency exchange as $\$10 \approx 8.57$ Euros, €. The symbol, $\approx$, means "is approximately equal to." This is the symbol often used to show the relationship between currencies instead of an equal sign, $=$.

Why do you think that is?

5.5.2 Exploration: Journey through Mathlandia

Similar to scale drawings, currency exchange, or currency **conversion**, is another application of ratios and rates in the real world.



A **unit conversion** rewrites a quantity from one unit to another without changing the value of the quantity. Unit conversions are used for measurements such as currency, mass, length, etc.

In class today, you will visit different countries in Mathlandia. In each country, you will see sets of souvenir items of the same value for sale, but with prices in each country’s currency. Use the table to record the prices of the items in each country. Place a star beside your “home” country. As you visit each country, you will work together to determine the exchange rate in comparison to your “home country.” Happy travels!

In the first column of the table, each country’s name is listed in bold. The country’s currency is listed below the country’s name with the symbol for its units in parentheses.

Write your “home” country’s name and currency on the lines provided.

“Home” Country Name _____

currency (units) _____

Price of Goods by Country

	Mug	Keychain	Magnet	T-shirt	Picture Frame
Scalenia sal (§)					
Prismopolis peak (Å)					
Proportia pop (ρ)					
Equivaland equi (€)					
Variableya var (v̂)					
Integerina op (⊕)					

1. Complete the statement to summarize the information given about the souvenir items in each country, using the words or phrases in the bank.

currency	equal to	value
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Each type of souvenir has the same _____, which means it is worth the same amount of money. The price of each item is listed in that country's _____. Because the price of each souvenir from each country has the same value, the prices in different currencies can be set _____ each other. This can then be used to determine a currency exchange rate that can be used to approximate the cost of other items.

2. With your partner, discuss how this information can be used to find the exchange rate between two currencies. Write a summary of your discussion.
3. Show an example of how to find the exchange rate between two currencies. Be sure to label the units.

4. Use the information you gathered on your journey to calculate the exchange rates for each of the other currencies in comparison to your “home” currency. Record them in the section of the table for your “home” country’s currency. Round to the nearest hundredth.

Exchange Rate	Unit	Exchange Rate	Unit
1 sal ≈	pop(s)	1 pop ≈	sal(s)
	peak(s)		peak(s)
	equi(s)		equi(s)
	var(s)		var(s)
	op(s)		op(s)
Exchange Rate	Unit	Exchange Rate	Unit
1 peak ≈	sal(s)	1 equi ≈	sal(s)
	pop(s)		pop(s)
	equi(s)		peak(s)
	var(s)		var(s)
	op(s)		op(s)
Exchange Rate	Unit	Exchange Rate	Unit
1 var ≈	sal(s)	1 op ≈	sal(s)
	pop(s)		pop(s)
	peak(s)		peak(s)
	equi(s)		equi(s)
	op(s)		var(s)

5. Review the exchange rates displayed by other groups. Complete the table with the exchange rates for each currency.

5.5.3 Bring it Together: Exchanging Currency

1. Write two observations you made about the currencies from the activity.
2. Write a ratio that can be used to represent the exchange rate of ops ($\oplus$) to peaks ($\text{\AA}$).
3. Write a ratio that can be used to represent the exchange rate of peaks ($\text{\AA}$) to ops ($\oplus$).
4. What do you notice about these two ratios?
5. A hat costs 255 peaks ($\text{\AA}$). Which ratio can be used to determine how much the same hat would cost in ops ($\oplus$)?
6. What is the cost of the hat in ops ($\oplus$)? Show your work.

5.5.4 Wrap-Up: Reflection

Complete each statement as you reflect on today's learning.

1. When someone asks me what I did in math class today, I can say ...
2. The thing that made the most sense to me today was ...
3. Something that I still do not understand is ...